

§8b d256·4 vs d128·8 (same shape N·D=1024) — per-step GPU-time in absolute ms, run order (1B/4096/lognormal bs32, GB300 8-GPU, shared y-axis)
the d256 bars are taller almost entirely via the red HSTU band (~57 vs ~30 ms); IDLE/GEMM/ELEM/EMB bands are ~identical — the faster d128·8 arm shows MORE exposed NCCL

